

Website Analytics Setup & Usage Guide

Google Analytics 4 · Google Tag Manager · Google Search Console

Website	Domain	GA4 property owner
Velocity Global	velocityglobal.com	Velocity Google account
KMF Nandhini	[fill in domain]	Client's Google account (Velocity added as Admin)

What this guide covers

- Creating GA4 properties and Search Console properties for both websites
- Installing tracking (Tag Manager, direct code, WordPress, React / Next.js)
- Tracking which pages visitors see and what they click (buttons, WhatsApp, phone, forms)
- Verifying that tracking works
- Reading the reports and sending a weekly analytics update

How to use this document

Follow Parts 1 to 7 once for **velocityglobal.com**, then repeat for **KMF Nandhini**. Fill in the Setup Record table in Part 9 as you go, so the IDs and access details are in one place.

0. The three tools and what each one does

Tool	What it answers	Where
Google Analytics 4 (GA4)	Who visits the site, where they come from, which pages they view, what they click, and whether they convert (enquiry, call, WhatsApp).	analytics.google.com
Google Tag Manager (GTM)	The container that loads GA4 and click tracking on the website. After it is installed once, new tracking can be added without editing website code.	tagmanager.google.com
Google Search Console (GSC)	How the site performs in Google Search: search queries, impressions, clicks, average position, and indexing errors.	search.google.com/search-console

Note

'Google Analytics' and 'GA4' are the same product now. The old Universal Analytics has been shut down, so every new setup is GA4. Measurement IDs start with **G-**, for example G-AB12CD34EF.

Semrush vs Google data

Tools like Semrush **estimate** traffic from rankings. GA4 and Search Console show **actual** data from Google. When the numbers disagree, trust GA4 for visits and GSC for search clicks.

Before you start

- A Google account for Velocity (for example a shared marketing@ account), not a personal Gmail that could leave with an employee.
- Admin access to each website: CMS login, hosting or code repository, whichever applies.
- Login to the domain registrar or DNS provider (GoDaddy, Hostinger, Cloudflare, etc.) for Search Console verification.
- For KMF Nandhini: confirmation from the client on which Google account should own the analytics.

Ownership rule: The client should own their analytics. Create KMF Nandhini's GA4 account and Search Console property under the client's Google account, or create it under Velocity and transfer ownership later. Velocity gets Administrator access. This avoids disputes if the engagement ends.

1. Create the GA4 account and property

Do this once per website. Estimated time: 10 minutes.

1. Go to **analytics.google.com** and sign in with the owner Google account.
2. Click **Admin** (gear icon, bottom-left), then **Create > Account**.
3. **Account name:** 'Velozity Global Solutions' (or 'KMF Nandhini' for the client). Leave the data-sharing boxes as they are and click Next.
4. **Property name:** 'velozityglobal.com - Website'. Set **Reporting time zone: India (GMT+05:30)** and **Currency: Indian Rupee (INR)**.
5. Fill in business details (industry, size) and choose objectives. 'Generate leads' is the right choice for both sites. Click **Create** and accept the terms.
6. Choose platform **Web**. Enter the website URL (https://velozityglobal.com) and a stream name ('Velozity Website').
7. Keep **Enhanced measurement** ON. Click the gear next to it and confirm these are enabled: Page views (including 'page changes based on browser history events'), Scrolls, Outbound clicks, Site search, Form interactions, Video engagement, File downloads.
8. Click **Create stream**. Copy the **Measurement ID (G-XXXXXXXXXX)** and paste it into the Setup Record in Part 9.

What you get automatically

Enhanced measurement automatically tracks page views, scroll depth (90%), outbound link clicks, file downloads and form starts or submits. No extra code is needed for these. Part 4 covers tracking specific buttons such as 'Contact Us', WhatsApp and phone.

1b. Important settings (do not skip)

Setting	Where in GA4	Set to
Data retention	Admin > Data collection and modification > Data retention	14 months (the default is only 2 months, which limits Explorations)
Internal traffic filter	Admin > Data streams > [stream] > Configure tag settings > Show more > Define internal traffic	Add the office IP address (search 'what is my IP' from the office network). Then go to Admin > Data filters and set the Internal Traffic filter to Active .
Unwanted referrals	Same 'Configure tag settings' page > List unwanted referrals	Add payment gateways if used (for example razorpay.com)
Google signals	Admin > Data collection and modification > Data collection	Optional. Adds demographics and cross-device data.
User access	Admin > Account access management	Owner: Admin. Marketing team member: Editor . People who only read reports: Viewer .

2. Install tracking on the website

Choose **one** method per website based on how the site is built. Method A is recommended for both sites.

If the website is...	Use
Any site where you can edit the HTML head once	Method A: Google Tag Manager (recommended)
A simple static or HTML site, with no plans for click tracking	Method B: Direct GA4 code
WordPress	Method C: Site Kit plugin, or GTM via a plugin
React / Next.js / Vite (custom-built)	Method D: Framework install

Common mistake

Install only one method. Installing GA4 twice (for example a WordPress plugin plus GTM) counts every visit twice.

Method A: Google Tag Manager (recommended)

1. Go to **tagmanager.google.com** > Create Account. Account name: 'Velozity Global'. Container name: 'velozityglobal.com'. Target platform: **Web**. Click Create.
2. GTM shows two code snippets. Copy them into the website: snippet 1 as high as possible inside **<head>**, snippet 2 immediately after the opening **<body>** tag, on **every page**. In most sites this means the shared layout or header template.
3. In GTM, go to **Tags > New**. Tag type: **Google Tag**. Tag ID: paste your **G-XXXXXXXXXX**.
4. Triggering: **Initialization - All Pages**. Name the tag 'GA4 - Google Tag' and Save.
5. Click **Preview**, enter the website URL and confirm that Tag Assistant shows the tag as **Fired**.
6. Click **Submit** > Version name 'GA4 base install' > **Publish**. Nothing goes live until you publish.

The GTM snippets look like this (use the real ones from your container, with your GTM-XXXXXXX ID):

```
<!-- 1. In <head> -->
<script>(function(w,d,s,l,i){w[l]=w[l]||[];w[l].push({'gtm.start':
new Date().getTime(),event:'gtm.js'});var f=d.getElementsByTagName(s)[0],
j=d.createElement(s),dl=l!='dataLayer'?'&l='+l:'';j.async=true;j.src=
'https://www.googletagmanager.com/gtm.js?id='+i+dl;f.parentNode.insertBefore(j,f);
})(window,document,'script','dataLayer','GTM-XXXXXXX');

<!-- 2. Right after <body> -->
<noscript><iframe src="https://www.googletagmanager.com/ns.html?id=GTM-XXXXXXX"
height="0" width="0" style="display:none;visibility:hidden"></iframe></noscript>
```

Method B: Direct GA4 code (no Tag Manager)

In GA4: Admin > Data streams > [your stream] > **View tag instructions** > Install manually.
Paste the code in the **<head>** of every page:

```
<!-- Google tag (gtag.js) -->
<script async src="https://www.googletagmanager.com/gtag/js?id=G-XXXXXXXXXX"></script>
<script>
  window.dataLayer = window.dataLayer || [];
  function gtag(){dataLayer.push(arguments);}
  gtag('js', new Date());
  gtag('config', 'G-XXXXXXXXXX');
</script>
```

Method C: WordPress

- **Option 1 (simplest):** Plugins > Add New > search '**Site Kit by Google**' > Install > Activate.
Run the setup, sign in with the owner Google account, and connect Analytics (choose the existing GA4 property) and Search Console. Site Kit verifies Search Console for you.
- **Option 2 (for click tracking):** Install a GTM plugin such as 'GTM4WP', paste the GTM-XXXXXXX ID, then follow Method A from step 3. If you use this, do not also connect Analytics in Site Kit.

Method D: React / Next.js (custom-built sites)

Next.js (App Router): install the official helper package and add it to the root layout:

```
npm install @next/third-parties

// app/layout.tsx
import { GoogleTagManager } from '@next/third-parties/google'
// or: import { GoogleAnalytics } from '@next/third-parties/google'

export default function RootLayout({ children }) {
  return (
    <html lang="en">
      <GoogleTagManager gtmId="GTM-XXXXXXX" />
      { /* or <GoogleAnalytics gaId="G-XXXXXXXXXX" /> */ }
      <body>{children}</body>
    </html>
  )
}
```

React / Vite (single-page app): paste the GTM or gtag snippet into **index.html** inside **<head>**. Keep 'page changes based on browser history events' **ON** in Enhanced measurement (Part 1, step 7) so page changes are counted without a full reload.

Developer check

For client-side routed apps, open 2-3 pages in Realtime after install to confirm each route change is recorded as a page_view. If only the first page appears, the history-change setting is off.

3. Verify that tracking works

1. Open the website in a normal browser window. Ad blockers and Brave block GA, so disable them for the test.
2. In GA4, open **Reports > Realtime**. You should appear as an active user within about 30 seconds, along with the page you are on.
3. Go to **tagassistant.google.com**, connect the website, and click through a few pages. Confirm the Google Tag and page_view events fire on each page.
4. For detailed checks, use **Admin > DebugView** while Tag Assistant is connected. It shows every event live.
5. Standard reports (not Realtime) fill in after **24-48 hours**. Empty standard reports on day one are normal.

After testing, confirm the internal traffic filter is **Active** so team visits do not inflate the numbers. It can be left in 'Testing' for the first day to check that it works.

4. Track what visitors click (buttons, WhatsApp, phone, forms)

Enhanced measurement already records outbound links and file downloads. For business-critical actions, create named events in GTM. Recommended events for both sites:

Event name	What it tracks	GTM trigger condition
whatsapp_click	Click on a WhatsApp button or link	Click URL contains wa.me OR contains api.whatsapp.com
phone_click	Click on a phone number	Click URL starts with tel:
email_click	Click on an email link	Click URL starts with mailto:
cta_click	Main buttons ('Get a Quote', 'Contact Us', 'Book a Call')	Click Text equals the button text, or Click Classes contains the button's CSS class
generate_lead	Enquiry or contact form successfully submitted	Page View on the thank-you page URL, or a Form Submission trigger

Step-by-step in GTM (example: WhatsApp click)

1. **Enable click variables:** Variables > Configure > tick all under **Clicks** (Click Element, Classes, ID, URL, Text). Do this once per container.
2. **Create the trigger:** Triggers > New > type **Click - Just Links** > 'Some Link Clicks' > **Click URL contains wa.me**. Name it 'Click - WhatsApp'. (For buttons that are not links, use **Click - All Elements**.)
3. **Create the tag:** Tags > New > type **Google Analytics: GA4 Event**. Measurement ID: G-XXXXXXXXXX. Event name: **whatsapp_click**.
4. Under Event Parameters, add **link_url** = {{Click URL}} and **page_location** = {{Page URL}}. This shows which page the click came from.
5. Set triggering to 'Click - WhatsApp'. Save.
6. Click **Preview**, click the WhatsApp button on the site, and confirm the tag fires. Then **Submit > Publish**.

7. Repeat for phone_click, email_click, cta_click and generate_lead.

Mark the important events as Key Events (conversions)

1. After the event has fired at least once (it can take up to 24 hours to appear), go to GA4 **Admin > Data display > Events**.
2. Click the star or toggle to mark **generate_lead, whatsapp_click and phone_click** as **Key events**. ('Key events' is GA4's current name for what used to be called conversions.)
3. To see custom parameters such as link_url in reports, go to **Admin > Data display > Custom definitions > Create custom dimension**, with scope Event and parameter link_url.

Tip

Forms are the most important thing to track correctly. The most reliable method is a dedicated **thank-you page** (for example /thank-you) that the form redirects to after submission, with a GTM trigger on that page view. Ask the developer to add one if the form only shows an inline 'Thanks' message.

5. Set up Google Search Console

1. Go to **search.google.com/search-console** > Add property.
2. Choose **Domain** property (recommended). Enter **velocityglobal.com** with no https:// or www. This covers all versions of the site: http, https, www and subdomains.
3. Google gives a **TXT record**. Log in to the DNS provider, add a TXT record on the root domain (Host '@') with that value, and save.
4. Return to Search Console and click **Verify**. DNS can take from a few minutes to several hours to update. If verification fails, retry later.
5. Alternative if DNS access is not available: choose **URL prefix** (https://velocityglobal.com/) and verify through **Google Analytics** or **Google Tag Manager**. This works automatically if the tag from Part 2 is live and the same Google account is used.
6. Go to **Sitemaps** in the left menu and submit **sitemap.xml** (or sitemap_index.xml on WordPress/Yoast). Status should show 'Success'.
7. Use **URL Inspection** (top search bar) on the homepage and key service pages > **Request indexing**.
8. Go to Settings > **Users and permissions** and add team members (Full or Restricted).

Link Search Console to GA4

1. GA4 **Admin > Product links > Search Console links** > Link.
2. Choose the Search Console property, then the web stream, then Submit.
3. In GA4 **Reports > Library**, open the **Search Console** collection and click **Publish**. Two new reports, Queries and Google organic search traffic, then appear in the left menu.

Search Console data takes **2-3 days** to start appearing and runs about 2 days behind. A new property does not show history from before it was created.

6. How to use the reports: where to find each answer

Question	Where to look
How many people visited?	GA4 > Reports > Acquisition > Overview . Look at Active users, New users and Sessions.
Where did they come from (Google, LinkedIn, Instagram, ads, direct)?	GA4 > Acquisition > Traffic acquisition . The default dimension is 'Session primary channel group'. Switch to 'Session source / medium' for detail.
Which pages do they view most?	GA4 > Engagement > Pages and screens . Views, Users and Average engagement time per page.
Which page do they land on first?	GA4 > Engagement > Landing page . Shows which pages bring people in.
What did they click?	GA4 > Engagement > Events . Open whatsapp_click, phone_click, cta_click, click (outbound links) and file_download.
How many leads?	GA4 > Engagement > Key events . Add a secondary dimension 'Session source / medium' to see which channel produced the leads.
What path did visitors take?	GA4 > Explore > Path exploration . Start from a page_view and follow the next pages.
Where do visitors drop off before enquiring?	GA4 > Explore > Funnel exploration . Example steps: Home > Services page > Contact page > generate_lead.
Which cities and devices?	GA4 > User > Demographics (City) and Tech (Device category).
What do people search on Google to find us?	Search Console > Performance > Search results > Queries tab. Clicks, Impressions, CTR, Position.
Which pages rank on Google?	Search Console > Performance > Pages tab.
Are any pages not indexed or broken?	Search Console > Pages (Indexing) and Core Web Vitals .

Useful habits inside GA4

- Always set the **date range** (top-right) and use 'Compare' against the previous period.
- Use **Add comparison** to split any report, for example 'Device category = mobile' vs desktop.
- Branded vs non-branded search: in Search Console Performance, add a filter **Query does not contain 'velocity'** to see non-branded demand. This is the real SEO growth signal.
- Save frequently used reports: click the share icon on a report and choose Download File (PDF/CSV) for sending.

7. Weekly and monthly reporting routine

Every Monday (15 minutes per site): send a short update covering the metrics below, for the last 7 days compared with the previous 7 days.

Metric	Source	Why it matters
Users and sessions	GA4 Acquisition overview	Overall reach
Top 3 traffic channels	GA4 Traffic acquisition	Which marketing effort is working
Top 5 pages	GA4 Pages and screens	What content attracts people
Leads (generate_lead + whatsapp_click + phone_click)	GA4 Key events	The number that matters most
Lead source	Key events + Session source / medium	Where leads come from
Search clicks and impressions	Search Console Performance	Google search visibility
Top 5 search queries	Search Console Queries	What people search for
New indexing errors	Search Console Pages	Catch technical problems early

Weekly update template (copy into WhatsApp or email)

Website Analytics – [Site name] – Week of [date]

Users: ____ (vs last week: +/- __%)
Sessions: ____
Top channels: 1) ____ 2) ____ 3) ____
Top pages: 1) ____ 2) ____ 3) ____
Leads: Forms ____ | WhatsApp ____ | Calls ____ (Total ____)
Best lead source: ____
Google Search: Clicks ____ | Impressions ____ | Avg position ____
Top queries: ____, ____, ____
Issues found / action for next week: ____

Monthly (first week of the month): the same metrics month-over-month, plus the funnel exploration from Part 6 and 2–3 recommended actions (for example 'Services page gets traffic but no enquiries: add a CTA above the fold').

Automate later

Optional: build a free **Looker Studio** dashboard (lookerstudio.google.com) connecting GA4 and Search Console for both sites. Use Share > Schedule delivery to email a PDF every Monday automatically.

8. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause and fix
Realtime shows 0 users	Tag not published in GTM (click Submit > Publish); wrong G- ID; code not on every page; ad blocker in your browser; site cache not cleared (purge the WordPress, Cloudflare or hosting cache).
Visits counted twice	GA4 installed twice, for example plugin plus GTM, or gtag plus GTM. Keep only one install.
Only the homepage appears (React/Next site)	Turn on 'page changes based on browser history events' in Enhanced measurement.
Custom event not showing in reports	Check DebugView first. New events take up to 24 hours to appear in standard reports.
Own website listed as a referral source	Add the domain under Configure tag settings > List unwanted referrals.
Search Console 'Verification failed'	The DNS TXT record has not propagated yet (wait and retry), or it was added to the wrong host (use '@').
Search Console shows no data	New property. Wait 2-3 days. Data is only collected from the date the property was verified.
Team visits inflating numbers	The internal traffic filter is still in 'Testing'. Set it to Active.

Consent banners

If the site shows a cookie consent banner, make sure accepting it does not block the GA tag. If GTM is set up with consent mode, check that analytics_storage is granted after the visitor clicks 'Accept'.

9. Setup record (fill in and keep safe)

Item	Velocity Global	KMF Nandhini
Website URL	https://velocityglobal.com	
Site platform (WordPress / Next.js / other)		
Owner Google account		
GA4 Account name		
GA4 Measurement ID (G-...)		
GTM Container ID (GTM-...)		
Search Console property type	Domain / URL prefix	Domain / URL prefix
Sitemap URL submitted		
GA4 <> Search Console linked (Y/N)		
Key events configured		
Internal traffic filter active (Y/N)		
Data retention = 14 months (Y/N)		
People with access + role		
Date completed / done by		

Completion checklist

- ☐ GA4 property created (IST time zone, INR currency)
- ☐ Enhanced measurement ON
- ☐ Data retention set to 14 months
- ☐ Tracking installed with one method only, and published
- ☐ Realtime shows visits
- ☐ WhatsApp / phone / CTA / lead events firing
- ☐ Key events marked
- ☐ Internal traffic filter Active
- ☐ Search Console verified and sitemap submitted
- ☐ GA4 linked to Search Console, collection published
- ☐ Access given to the right people
- ☐ First weekly report sent